

New driver onboarding · packet index

For John Doe · Acme Trucking LLC

Every new CDL driver hire generates ~20 documents across §391 (Driver Qualification), §382 (D&A), FCRA (consumer reports), §172.704 (Hazmat if applicable), and company policy. This packet index lists what must exist before the driver's first safety-sensitive trip.

I · DAY 1 · PRE-SCREENING (DRIVER HASN'T BEEN HIRED YET)

1. **Driver's application** · long-form per §391.21 · 3 years of address + 10 years of employment history
2. **FCRA disclosure + authorization** · standalone form · 15 U.S.C. §1681b(b)(2)(A)
3. **D&A consent** · for pre-employment drug test + previous-employer D&A inquiries
4. **Clearinghouse full-query consent** · electronic consent in clearinghouse.fmcsa.dot.gov
5. **State MVR consent** · for every state the driver has been licensed in (past 3 years)

II · DAY 1-3 · VERIFICATION (RUNNING IN PARALLEL)

1. **Initial MVRs** · pulled from every relevant state · §391.23(a)(1)
2. **Clearinghouse pre-employment full query** · run with driver's electronic consent · §382.701(a)
3. **Pre-employment DOT drug test** · drug only, no alcohol · negative result required before safety-sensitive duty
4. **Previous-employer DOT employment + D&A inquiries** · for every DOT-regulated employer in the past 3 years · §391.23(d) + §40.25
5. **Background check** · if your hiring standard includes it · ordered through Checkr or similar with FCRA-compliant disclosure
6. **Medical certificate verification** · examiner verified on NRCME · certificate copy in file · CDLIS shows current

III · DAY 3-7 · ONCE CLEARED (DRIVER IS NOW HIREABLE)

1. **Road test or CDL-on-file equivalent** · §391.31 / §391.33 · usually a road test for first hire

2. **Entry-level driver training (ELDT) certificate** · for CDL holders licensed after 02/07/2022 · §380.609 · from the FMCSA Training Provider Registry
3. **D&A policy receipt** · driver acknowledges receipt of the written policy · §382.601
4. **Hazmat training documentation** · only if the role requires HM endorsement work · §172.704 · within 90 days of employment
5. **Annual general written consent for limited Clearinghouse queries** · §382.701(b)
6. **I-9 + W-4** · standard employment forms (not DOT, but day-1 standard)
7. **Direct deposit + benefits enrollment** · company-specific

IV · WITHIN 30 DAYS · AUDIT-READY DQ FILE COMPLETE

By day 30, the driver's file should contain all 12 §391.51 documents (see the DQF Driver Index). The most-missed items at this stage:

- **NRCME verification date recorded** · not just the medical card
- **Previous-employer responses received** · not just "we tried" attempt logs · the actual responses or non-response documentation
- **Hazmat function-specific training** · within 90 days · don't drift past it
- **ELDT certificate** · for any post-Feb-2022 CDL · easy to forget for in-house transfers
- **Annual driver review** calendared 12 months from hire

X3 Compass's onboarding workflow generates this packet from the moment a driver enters the system · every required document has a status pill (Open / In progress / Complete) and the safety director can't mark the hire complete until every document is green.